

Notes: L3 | Thalāthah Al-Uṣūl

The ‘Ulamā’ gave great concern for this book, and taught it many times due to the benefit it contains. And studying ‘Ilm (Islamic knowledge) has grace and bounty as the Prophet ﷺ said:

قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ: "فَضْلُ الْعِلْمِ خَيْرٌ مِنْ فَضْلِ الْعِبَادَةِ"

The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: "The bounty and grace of knowledge is better than the bounty and grace of worship." Muṣṭafā al-Ḥākim, al-Albānī deemed it as Ṣaḥīḥ li ḡayriḥ.

In explanation of this ḥadīth, sheikh Sulaymān Ar-Ruḡaylī said that seeking knowledge that is voluntary is better than increasing in voluntary ‘ibādah, due to this ḥadīth. Some of the people of knowledge from the muḥaqqiqūn also explained that if the ‘abd can only do one, it is better for him to increase in voluntary knowledge rather than voluntary acts of worship.

Seeking knowledge in itself is also an act of worship, let’s not forget that.

Sheikh ibn ‘Uthaymīn رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ said in his explanation of *Thalāthah Al-Uṣūl*¹:

التوحيد هو إفراد الله بالعبادة.
وَالْعِبَادَةُ كَمَا قَالَ ابْنُ تَيْمِيَّةٍ "هِيَ اسْمٌ جَامِعٌ لِكُلِّ مَا يُحِبُّهُ اللَّهُ وَيَرْضَاهُ: مِنَ الْأَقْوَالِ وَالْأَعْمَالِ
الْبَاطِنَةِ وَالظَّاهِرَةِ"

وأنواع التوحيد ثلاثة:

١- توحيد الربوبية وهو "إفراد الله سبحانه وتعالى بالخلق، والملك والتدبير.

Tawḥīd is to single out Allaah with all worship.

And as Ibn Taymiyyah said², Al-‘Tbādah (Worship) is a comprehensive term covering everything that Allah loves and is pleased with of sayings and actions, outward and inward.

And the types of tawḥīd are three:

1- Tawḥīd Ar-Rubūbiyyah (Lordship) – singling out Allah (with His Actions): Al-Khalq (creation), [Ar-Razq³ (Providing Sustenance),] Al-Mulk (The Dominion) , At-Tadbīr (The disposition of affairs).

¹ Published by Al-Hidaayah in the English language

² Majmū‘ Al-Fatāwa vol 10, pg. 149

³ Razq is the Action of Allah giving out the sustenance, Rizq is the sustenance itself as explained by Sheikh Ṣāliḥ Al-Fawzān *Ḥafidhabu* Allah (May Allah preserve him).

٢- توحيد الألوهية وهو "إفراد الله سبحانه وتعالى بالعبادة بأن، لا يتخذ الإنسان مع الله أحداً يعبدته ويتقرب إليه كما يعبد الله تعالى ويتقرب إليه.

2- Tawḥīd Al-Ulūhiyyah/ Al-'Ubūdiyyah / Al-'Ibādah (Worship) – To single out Allah with worship, (such that) a person does not take anyone else besides Allah by worshipping him and seeking nearness to him as he worships and seeks nearness to Allah.

٢- توحيد الأسماء والصفات وهو إفراد الله تعالى بما سمي به نفسه ووصف به نفسه في كتابه، أو على لسان رسوله صلى الله عليه وسلم وذلك بإثبات ما أثبتته، ونفي ما نفاه من غير تحريف، ولا تعطيل، ومن غير تكييف، ولا تمثيل.

Tawḥīd Al-Asmā' Wa Aṣ-Ṣifāt (The Names and Attributes) – To single out Allah with whatever Names and Attributes He has affirmed for Himself in His Book, or upon the tongue of His Messenger ﷺ; and this is by affirming whatever He has affirmed for Himself, and denying whatever He has denied from Himself, without *Taḥrīf* (distortion), *Ta'ṭīl* (rendering them as void/hollow), *Takyīf* (asking the how), and without *Tamthīl* (likening Him to His creation).

يقول ابن حجر رحمه الله: "وَقَدْ جَمَعْتُ كُتُبَ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ إِلَى الْمُلُوكِ وَغَيْرِهِمْ، فَلَمْ يَقَعْ فِي وَاحِدٍ مِنْهَا الْبَدَاءَةُ بِالْحَمْدِ بَلْ بِالْبَسْمَلَةِ⁴."

Ibn ḥajar Raḥimahu Allah said: I have gathered the prophet's letters to the kings and others, and not in one of them the starting with with *Al-Ḥamd*, rather by *Al-Basmalah* (i.e. Bismillahi Ar-Raḥmāni Ar-Raḥīmi)⁵.

When starting the book, the author Raḥimahu Allah always begins by saying *I'lam* (have knowledge that), and sheikh ibn 'Uthaymīn has explained (in his sharḥ of *Thalāthat Al-Uṣūl*) that:

العلم هو إدراك الشيء على ما هو عليه إدراكاً جازماً. [زاد الشيخ سليمان الرحيلي: لا إحتمال معه.

Al-'Ilm: is knowing something upon its reality, decisively. [Sheikh Sulaymān Ar-Ruḥaylī added:] without any other possibilities with it.

The author (Sheikh Muḥammad Bin 'Abdil-Waḥḥāb) then says: "Bismillah."
What does it mean? Sheikh Ibn 'Uthaymīn explains⁶ that:

⁴ ج ١٣ ص ١٢٩ - فتح الباري بشرح البخاري ط الرسالة

⁵ *Fatḥ Al-Bārī A Sharḥ Of Ṣaḥīḥ Al-Bukhārī*, Vol. 13, Pg. 129, Published by "Ar-Risālah" (Arabic Book)

⁶ *Sharḥ Bayqūniyah*, Arabic book pg 18-19; English book pg 29-30, published by Dar Al-Arqam.



قاعدة: أن **المفرد** المضاف يفيد العموم، فبذلك يلزم من قولنا: **بسم الله**، أن يكون المعنى: بكل اسم من أسماء الله الحسنى. ولهذا تجد القائل: **بسم الله**، لا يخطر بباله اسم معين كالرحمن والرحيم والغفور والودود والشكور ونحوها، بل هو يريد العموم ويدل على ذلك، أي على أن المفرد المضاف للعموم قوله تعالى: ﴿وَأِنْ تَعَدُّوا نِعْمَةَ اللَّهِ لَا تُحْصُوهَا إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لَظَلُومٌ كَفَّارٌ﴾ [إبراهيم: ٣٤]. ولو كان المراد نعمة واحدة لما قال: ﴿لَا تُحْصُوهَا﴾. إذاً فالمعنى ابتدئ بكل اسم من أسماء الله عز وجل.

Qā'idah (rule): any singular *mudaf* (possession) indicates generality. Henceforth it is understood from one who says, "Bismillah", that he intends all of the beautiful Names of Allah. As such you will find that the one who says, "Bismillah", it does not occur to him a certain name such as *Al-Rahmān* (the Merciful), *Al-Rahīm* (the Mercify giving), *Al-Ghafūr* (The Most Forgiving), *al-Wadūd* (the Affectionate) or *Al-Shakūr* (the Grateful) etc. The one making the statement intends generalization. And what brings evidence to this, meaning that the singular *mudaf* indicates generality, is the ayah: ﴿and if you were to count the Blessings of Allāh, you could not enumerate them. Verily, man is indeed an extreme wrong-doer, a disbeliever (an extreme ingrate who denies Allāh's Blessings by disbelief, and by worshipping others besides Allāh, and by disobeying Allāh and His Prophet Muhammad ﷺ).﴾ [Surah Ibrāhīm (14:34)]. If what is meant in the ayah is a single favour, ﴿you could not enumerate them﴾ would not have been said. Therefore, the meaning (of Bismillah) is, "I start my action with every one of all the beautiful Asmā' (Names) of Allah."

والباء في قوله: **بسم الله**:

لا شك أن المراد بالباء هو: الاستعانة التي تصاحب كل الفعل، فهي في الأصل للاستعانة وهي مصاحبة للإنسان من أول الفعل إلى آخره، وقد تفيد معنى آخر وهو التبرك إذا لم نحمل التبرك على الاستعانة، ونقول كل مستعين بشيء فإنه متبرك به.

And the preposition *bā'* in the saying "*bismillah*":

It is beyond doubt that the preposition *bā'* refers to *Al-isti'ānah* that accompanies every action due to the fact that it is originally for seeking assistance which accompanies the person from the start of the action until the end. It could also refer to another meaning which is *Al-Tabarruk* (the seeking of Barakah i.e. blessings). If we do not take *Al-isti'ānah* as carrying the meaning of *Al-Tabarruk*, we can still say that every person seeking assistance with something is seeking its blessings as well.

Da'wah to Allah should be preceded by:

1. Sincerity, for the face of Allah; And as Sheikh Ibn 'Uthaymīn explained:



تقصد به وجه الله عز وجل، يعني تقصد به أن تصل إلى الجنة؛ حتى ترى وجه الله عز وجل. لأن أهل الجنة - جعلني الله وإياكم منهم - يرون الله سبحانه وتعالى، وينظرون إليه عياناً بأبصارهم، كما يرون الشمس صحوً ليس دونها سحب، وكما يرون القمر ليلة البدر. يعني أنهم يرون ذلك حقاً.⁷

That is, you seek Allah's Face with it; you hope to be admitted into Al-Jannah (Paradise) so that you see the Face of Allah Subhānah Wa Ta'āla (free is He from all imperfections and Exalted is He). This is because the people of Al-Jannah - may Allah make me and you among them - will see Allah Subhānah Wa Ta'āla -. They will see Him clearly with their eyes as they plainly see the sun without any cloud obstructing it and in the manner they see the moon during the nights of a full moon. That is to say, they shall most truly see that.⁸

2. Having knowledge

﴿قُلْ هَذِهِ سَبِيلِي أَدْعُو إِلَى اللَّهِ عَلَىٰ بَصِيرَةٍ أَنَا وَمَنِ اتَّبَعَنِي ۖ وَسُبْحَنَ اللَّهُ وَمَا أَنَا مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ﴾

﴿Say (O Muhammad ﷺ): "This is my way; I invite unto Allāh (i.e. to the Oneness of Allāh - Islāmīc Monotheism) with sure knowledge, I and whosoever follows me (also must invite others to Allāh i.e. to the Oneness of Allāh - Islāmīc Monotheism with sure knowledge). And Glorified and Exalted be Allāh (above all that they associate as partners with Him). And I am not of the Mushrikūn (polytheists, pagans, idolaters and disbelievers in the Oneness of Allāh; those who worship others along with Allāh or set up rivals or partners to Allāh).﴾" [(Surah Yūsuf 12:108)]

3. Done with wisdom and patience

Ibn Taymiyyah said: mentioned⁹:

"وَقَدْ ذَكَرَ اللَّهُ الصَّبْرَ فِي كِتَابِهِ فِي أَكْثَرِ مِنْ تِسْعِينَ مَوْضِعًا"

"And Verily ṣabr was mentioned in His Book in more than 90 places."

4. Knowing the condition of those who we're calling.

Regarding the saying of Ash-Shafi'i, Sheikh Ibn 'Uthaymīn said in his sharḥ of *Thalāthah Al-Uṣūl*:

⁷ ج 1 ص 45 - شرح رياض الصالحين لابن عثيمين - باب الإخلاص وإحضار النية في جميع الأعمال والأقوال البارزة والخفية

⁸ Ibn 'Uthaymīn's Sharḥ of Riyāḍ Aṣ-ṣāliḥīn - Chapter on Sincerity and Significance of Intentions for All Actions and Statements, the Apparent and the Hidden" Vol 1, Pg. 45.

⁹ Majmū' Al-Fatāwa vol 10, pg. 39



مراده رحمه الله أن هذه السورة كافية للخلق في الحث على التمسك بدين الله بالإيمان، والعمل الصالح، والدعوة إلى الله، والصبر على ذلك، وليس مراده أن هذه السورة كافية للخلق في جميع الشريعة. وقوله: "لَوْ مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ حُجَّةً عَلَى خَلْقِهِ إِلَّا هَذِهِ السُّورَةُ لَكَفَتْهُمْ" لأن العاقل البصير إذا سمع هذه السورة أو قرأها فلا بد أن يسعى إلى تخليص نفسه من الخسران وذلك باتصافه بهذه الصفات الأربع: الإيمان، والعمل الصالح، والتواصي بالحق والتواصي بالصبر.

What he means is that this Sūrah is sufficient for the creation as an encouragement to adhere to the Religion of Allah by true īmān (faith), Al-ʿAmal Aṣ-Ṣāliḥ (righteous actions), Daʿwah (calling) to Allah, and having Aṣ-Ṣabr (patience) upon that. He does not mean that this Sūrah is sufficient for the creation with regard to all matters of the Religion and its prescriptions. His (Ash-Shafiʿī's) saying: "Had Allah not sent down a *Hujjah* (evidence) to His creation other than this surah, it would have been sufficient for them" is because an intelligent and discerning person who hears this Sūrah or recites it must necessarily hasten to free himself from the state of loss by attaining these four characteristics: True īmān (faith), Al-ʿAmal Aṣ-Ṣāliḥ (righteous actions), mutual waṣiyyah (enjoinment) upon the truth, and mutual enjoinment of Aṣ-Ṣabr (patient perseverance).

وَالْإِيمَانُ: (١) هُوَ اِعْتِقَادٌ بِالْجَنَانِ، (٢) وَقَوْلٌ بِاللِّسَانِ، (٣) وَعَمَلٌ بِالْجَوَارِحِ وَالْأَرْكَانِ، يَزِيدُ بِالطَّاعَةِ وَيَنْقُصُ بِالْعِصْيَانِ.

And īmān is (1) faith within the heart, (2) the saying with the tongue, and (3) the actions with the limbs; it increases with obedience and decreases with disobedience.

Shirk as well is these three aspects i.e. in the heart, in sayings and in actions as well.

The ḥadīth:

"الدعاء مخ العبادة¹⁰. "ضعفه الألباني

"Ad-Duʿā (Supplication) is the core of Al-ʿIbādah (Worship)", was weakened by Al-Albānī.

And the authentic one is:

عَنْ الثُّعْمَانِ بْنِ بَشِيرٍ عَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ "الدُّعَاءُ هُوَ الْعِبَادَةُ"

Al-Nuʿmān ibn Bashīr reported: The Prophet, peace and blessings be upon him, said: "Surely Supplication is worship itself." Sunan al-Tirmidhī, Al-Albānī deemed it as Ṣaḥīḥ.

¹⁰ ص 441 - كتاب ضعيف الجامع الصغير وزيادته

